



News, Events, and Opportunities for Students

NEAREST DEADLINE

Paid Research at Brookhaven: 30 September, 5:00 PM Eastern Time

FROM THE EDITOR

This is the first issue of GES-NEWS, a monthly newsletter for students in the Department of Geology, Environment and Sustainability (GES) and in related subject areas. This newsletter brings together in one place: deadlines, internships, scholarships, field trips, volunteer opportunities, upcoming talks, news about courses, and updates on the work faculty and students in this department are doing.

To keep receiving GES-NEWS, [subscribe here](#). To send in an article or an item, see the last section.

CLOSING SOON

Paid Research at Brookhaven INTERNSHIP

Science Undergraduate Laboratory Internships (SULI), spring 2027

Closes 30 September, 5:00 PM Eastern Time

A paid, full-time research internship for one semester at a national laboratory, working beside a staff scientist. Brookhaven National Laboratory in Upton is one of the seventeen participating laboratories, so this one is reachable without leaving Long Island. It is run by the Office of Science of the United States Department of Energy (DOE), and it pays a stipend with housing and travel allowances.

This is the spring term, so you would be away from campus in spring 2027. The summer 2027 round usually closes in January and is not posted yet.

Apply: science.osti.gov/wdts/suli

Fund Your Own Research

GRANT

Sigma Xi Grants in Aid of Research

Closes 1 October

A small grant you apply for yourself, to pay the real costs of your own research: field travel, laboratory analyses, supplies. Sigma Xi is a scientific research society; it is open to any undergraduate or graduate student in a degree programme, and you do not need to be a member of Sigma Xi to apply.

Undergraduates can receive \$500 to \$2,000 if the student or the advisor is an active Sigma Xi member, and up to \$1,000 otherwise. There is a second cycle every 15 March.

If you have never applied for anything of this kind, this is a good first one. The application is short, and the money pays for work you want to do anyway.

The application is short, and the money pays for work you want to do anyway.

Apply: sigmaxi.org/programs/grants-in-aid-of-research

Present Your Work in Philadelphia

CONFERENCE

Middle States Regional Meeting, American Association of Geographers (AAG)

Abstracts due 3 October. Conference 23 to 24 October, Philadelphia

A regional conference where undergraduates present their own research as a poster or a talk, or attend without presenting. It is hosted this year by Thomas Jefferson University in Philadelphia, and it brings together geographers from the region and beyond. Students may also take part in the Geography Bowl, a quiz competition with students from other colleges.

The conference dates are confirmed on the association's own page. The abstract deadline is not on that page yet; it comes from Dr. Pesci, who is coordinating student attendance.

Details: aag.org/events/2026-middle-states-aag-regional-meeting

Present Your Research at Rutgers

CONFERENCE

Rutgers Climate Symposium 2026, Rutgers Climate and Energy Institute

Poster abstracts close 9 November. Registration closes 12 November

A free, one-day symposium on this year's theme, "Sowing Change: Rethinking Farming in a Climate and Energy Transition," at the Douglass Student Center in New Brunswick, New Jersey, on Wednesday 18 November. It is open to students, faculty and staff of academic and research institutions in the Mid-Atlantic region. Posters are not limited to the symposium's theme, and undergraduate and graduate students, along with faculty, staff and postdoctoral researchers, may submit one. The poster session runs from 1:30 to 3:00 PM.

There is no charge to attend, but registration is required.

Details, to register, and to submit a poster abstract: ruclimatesymposium.rutgers.edu

ON CAMPUS EVENTS

Skip the Car for a Day

EVENT

Car Free Day Long Island

Tuesday 22 September

Pledge to reduce your driving, or not to drive at all, for the day. Dr. Bennington plans to ride his bicycle to campus that day.

Real Jobs, Real Alumni

EVENT

Alumni career talks in GEOL 005

15 and 22 October

Three graduates of this department come back to talk about the careers they built:

- ◆ Marrakech Cunliffe, sustainability (Thursday 15 October, 12:30 PM)
- ◆ Doug Ferraiolo, hydrology, more than a decade in the field (Thursday 22 October, 11:30 AM)
- ◆ Fran Grassia, environmental geology (Thursday 22 October, 12:15 PM)

Gittleson 162, and on Zoom. For the Zoom link or any other information, write to Dr. Farmer (GEOECF@hofstra.edu).

Help at the Bird Sanctuary

EVENT

Bird sanctuary cleanup and invasive species control

Friday 9 October, 1:00 to 3:00 PM

Meet at the Bird Sanctuary: the entrance is across the parking lot next to the University Club, on the north campus. We will pull out invasive plants (species that do not belong here and crowd out the local ones) and collect litter. Contact: Dr. Bennington.

[Sign up](#)

OFF CAMPUS EVENTS

Free Dinner, Real Geologists

EVENT

Long Island Association of Professional Geologists

Next dinner meeting in early December. The date is not set yet

The association holds a dinner meeting every quarter, with talks and panel discussions on geoscience research topics and on working in environmental and geotechnical consulting. It sponsors up to five students at each meeting, so those students eat for free, and the department can usually arrange a van from campus. The September meeting has passed. Dr. Bennington coordinates attendance and transportation.

A Day With the Native Plant Initiative

EVENT

Long Island Native Plant Initiative, at the Sisters of St. Joseph, Brentwood, New York

Saturday 24 October, 9:00 AM to 2:00 PM

A day of volunteer restoration work with the Long Island Native Plant Initiative. Depart from the Gittleson Hall loading dock at 9:00 AM. Contact: Dr. Bennington.

[Sign up](#)

ACADEMIC CALENDAR AND OTHER DATES TO KNOW

- ♦ **27 September (Sunday):** absolute last day to register or add a class with department permission, and last day to drop a course without a "W" on your transcript.
- ♦ **1 October (Thursday):** last day to apply for graduation without an extra fee.

Worth knowing: an independent study can start at 1 credit, up to 3, and counts in your grade point average. Ask a faculty member in your area whether one is a fit, and keep your semester at 17 credits or under.

Checked against Hofstra's own calendar, 19 September 2026: hofstra.edu/academics/calendar/fall-2026.

GES LINKEDIN GROUP

GES has a LinkedIn group, "Hofstra Geology, Environment, & Sustainability", with more than 100 members: graduates, current students and faculty. Internships and jobs are posted there, many of them by Dr. Farmer, one of the group's administrators. She says that graduates of this department have found jobs through the contacts they keep there. The group is private: ask to join, and current and former GES students are approved. Questions: Dr. Farmer (GEOECF@hofstra.edu).

Join: [linkedin.com/groups/8660377](https://www.linkedin.com/groups/8660377)

ONE OF OURS

Renee Lista, a graduate student in this department, was profiled in Hofstra News on 31 August for her work in sustainability. The article describes how she came to the field and what she is working on now.

Read it: news.hofstra.edu

LOOKING TO NEXT SUMMER

The summer positions below are decided in the winter, but the application work starts now.

A Paid Summer on a Sustainability Team

INTERNSHIP

Green Teams, PSEG Institute for Sustainability Studies, Montclair State University, summer 2027

Closes 29 January 2027

Eleven weeks of full-time, paid work in a team of five students, on a sustainability project set by a host organisation: a company, a town, a community group, a government agency or a non-profit organisation. The programme is run at Montclair State University in New Jersey by an institute supported by the foundation of PSEG (Public Service Enterprise Group), a New Jersey energy company. It is for undergraduates who will have finished at least their first year by summer 2027, from any major and any university. It includes training and meetings with people who work in the field.

It runs from 24 May to 5 August 2027 and pays a \$7,500 stipend, with housing. Questions: GreenTeamsApply@montclair.edu.

Details: inside.montclair.edu/pseg_iss. Apply: [application form](#)

Two Years of Tuition, Paid

SCHOLARSHIP

Hollings Undergraduate Scholarship

Closes 31 January 2027, 11:59 PM Eastern Time

Two years of tuition support, up to \$9,500 each year, and a paid ten-week research internship at a facility of the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA).

You must be one of these: a full-time second-year student in a four-year programme, a full-time third-year student in a five-year programme, or a community college (a two-year college) or transfer student who is applying to a four-year institution. You must be a citizen of the United States and hold a cumulative grade point average of at least 3.0. Eligible subjects include environmental, oceanic, atmospheric and biological sciences, geography, physics, hydrology, mathematics, engineering, remote sensing, and computer and information science.

Applications are open now.

Apply: noaa.gov/office-education/hollings-scholarship

Summer Job: National Park

INTERNSHIP

Scientists in Parks, summer 2027

Applications open in mid-December

A paid placement in a national park doing real resource work: geological mapping, monitoring, geographic information systems, and explaining the park's science to visitors. It is run by the National Park Service with the Geological Society of America (GSA).

Their page says positions close once they receive 60 applications, so a position can close before its deadline.

Details: scientistsinparks.org/how-to-apply

Paid Research, an Hour Away

INTERNSHIP

Lamont-Doherty Summer Intern Program

2027 dates not posted yet. Watch from early January

Ten weeks of paid summer research in Earth, ocean, atmospheric and environmental science at Lamont-Doherty Earth Observatory in Palisades, New York, about an hour from campus. The 2026 round paid a \$7,000 stipend with free accommodation in a hall of residence.

This is a Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) site of the National Science Foundation (NSF). It accepts students who have finished their second year as well as those who have finished their third. Students in their final year are not eligible. Some of

the positions are funded by the REU award, which is open only to citizens and permanent residents of the United States; other positions are not REU-funded and are open to more students.

Their page says the summer 2027 round is not open yet. The 2026 round opened on 19 January.

Details: lamont.columbia.edu

Hofstra's Top Science Scholarship SCHOLARSHIP

Barry Goldwater Scholarship

Hofstra nominates. Hofstra deadline 15 October

The main national scholarship for undergraduates who intend to become research scientists, open to second- and third-year students in the natural sciences, mathematics and engineering.

You cannot apply directly. Hofstra nominates its candidates. To be considered, meet **Dr. Matthew Smylie**, Hofstra's campus representative, and give him a signed endorsement letter from a faculty member by 15 October. He chooses who Hofstra nominates and is looking for candidates now. Hofstra expects a grade point average of at least 3.5 in your major and 3.25 overall, and research experience after high school. Hofstra's nominations are due on 29 January 2027. Hofstra has had three Goldwater scholars, all of them within the last six years.

Hofstra has had three Goldwater scholars, all of them within the last six years.

Details: sites.google.com/hofstra.edu/prestigious-scholarships

Three Years, Fully Funded FELLOWSHIP

For final-year students: NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program (GRFP)

Geosciences closes 23 October 2026, 8:00 PM Eastern Time

Three years of funded graduate study, applied for in your final year of college, before you have been admitted anywhere. It pays a \$37,000 stipend each year and \$16,000 towards the cost of education, for three years that you can use at any point within a five-year window of graduate study.

It is open to students in their final year, recent graduates, and first-year graduate students who are citizens, nationals or permanent residents of the United States. Second-year graduate students are not eligible. Other subjects have different dates: Life Sciences 19 October, Computer and Social Sciences 20 October, Engineering 22 October. Reference letters are due first: Friday 16 October, 8:00 PM Eastern Time.

Apply: nsf.gov/funding/opportunities/grfp

NOT OPEN YET, WORTH WATCHING

Give Your First Talk CONFERENCE

GSA Northeastern Section Meeting

Saratoga Springs, New York, 11 to 14 March 2027. Abstract deadline not posted yet

This is the regional geology conference, and it is where an undergraduate gives a first poster or talk to a real scientific audience. Undergraduate posters are common there, and welcome.

Undergraduate posters are common there, and welcome.

The abstract deadline has not been posted. The GSA page currently says to check back in the autumn. Comparable section meetings have closed abstracts in early to mid December, so watch the page from late October.

Watch: geosociety.org/events/section-meetings/northeastern

\$2,000 for Your Project

GRANT

Stephen G. Pollock Undergraduate Student Research Grants

Opens 15 January, closes 10 April

Up to \$2,000 for your own undergraduate research project, from the Northeastern Section of GSA, which covers New York. It is for undergraduates who are student members of GSA, and applicants should plan to present their results at a GSA meeting.

This grant and the Saratoga Springs meeting above work as a pair: the grant pays for the work, and the meeting is where you present it.

Details: geosociety.org/northeastern-section

WRITE FOR GES-NEWS

GES-NEWS is looking for student contributing editors, whose names are printed at the top of every issue they work on.

What contributors write:

- ◆ A first-person account of an internship, a field season, or a summer project
- ◆ Your own research finding, written so that a first-year student understands it
- ◆ A report from an event, a field trip or a conference, with photographs
- ◆ A profile of a student in the department, or of a graduate and where they are now
- ◆ Anything about student life in GES that other students would want to know

None of it is scientific writing.

It is writing for people outside your subject, which is a separate skill and a useful one to have.

To contribute a piece, or to join as a contributing editor for the year, write to the editor with GES-NEWS in the subject line.

How the dates are checked. Every application deadline in this issue was checked between 17 and 22 September 2026 on the website of the organisation that offers it. The details of campus events come from the faculty members who run them. If an organisation has not posted next year's deadline yet, as with the Lamont-Doherty summer internship and the regional geology meeting in March, this newsletter says "not posted yet". It does not print last year's date, because that application is already closed. Some scholarships are not applied for directly: the university nominates you, so there is an internal Hofstra deadline months before the national one, as with the Goldwater Scholarship above.

GES-NEWS is published for students of the Department of Geology, Environment and Sustainability at Hofstra University, nine issues a year, September to May. If you find an error, write to the editor and it will be corrected in the next issue.

Founding Editor: Dr. Antonios E. Marsellos. Co-Editor: Dr. J Bret Bennington.

Contributors to this issue: Dr. E. Christa Farmer, Dr. Sasha Pesci, Dr. Jase Bernhardt.